

WR-IV Mathematical Spine v0.3

Response-Conditioned Global Completion and the Status of the Past

A. A. Malachevsky

ORCID: 0009-0008-6009-3196

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Abstract

WR-IV studies historical ambiguity inside response-conditioned global completions. Given present data D , the globally compatible world class $\mathfrak{C}(D)$ is projected onto declared past-history spaces. This separates world-level nonuniqueness from past-level nonuniqueness and from nonuniqueness of observable historical records. Accumulated hard constraints give nested completion classes, possibly equal, without altering retained histories. A natural-extension benchmark for the doubling map shows that an exactly known present state may have a unique deterministic future while admitting a Cantor family of compatible full pasts. A second, physical inverse-problem benchmark uses fixed-interval smoothing of a diffusion: an endpoint observation reduces interior-state variance while the conditioned path law remains non-degenerate. Full-history compatibility and uncertainty about a fixed earlier fragment are distinguished. No claim of physical past creation, retrocausality, or branching ontology is made.

1 Claim ceiling

WR-IV inherits response equivalence and completion-fibre language from WR-I–III [1, 2, 3]. It assumes a model in which a temporal decomposition is already meaningful. It does not infer physical time from WREH itself. It does not claim observation creates or rewrites the past, that mathematical completion implies physical existence, or that noninvertibility implies a branching ontology.

2 Response-conditioned completions

Let

$$\mathfrak{C}(D) = \{W \in \mathcal{W} : W \text{ is globally compatible with } D\}.$$

A declared historical projection is a map

$$\pi_- : \mathcal{W} \rightarrow \mathcal{H}_-.$$

Definition 2.1 (Past-completion set).

$$\mathfrak{H}_-(D) := \pi_-(\mathfrak{C}(D)).$$

Definition 2.2 (Past rigidity). *D is past-rigid if $\mathfrak{H}_-(D)$ is a singleton, and world-rigid if $\mathfrak{C}(D)$ is a singleton.*

Proposition 2.3 (World rigidity implies past rigidity). *If D is world-rigid, then D is past-rigid.*

Proof. The image of a singleton under any map is a singleton. $\square$

Proposition 2.4 (The converse fails). *Past rigidity need not imply world rigidity.*

Proof. Take $\mathcal{W} = \{(h_0, 0), (h_0, 1)\}$, set $\mathfrak{C}(D) = \mathcal{W}$, and project both worlds onto h_0 . Then $\mathfrak{H}_-(D) = \{h_0\}$, although $\mathfrak{C}(D)$ has two elements. $\square$

3 Evidence refinement and non-rewriting

Throughout refinement, $\mathcal{W}$, the reference temporal cut, and π_- are fixed. Write $D \preceq D'$ when D' contains all hard constraints of D and possibly further constraints. This order does not include a change of model or replacement of previous data. Refinement may leave the completion set unchanged or make it empty; consistency is stated separately when needed.

Theorem 3.1 (Completion refinement). *If $D \preceq D'$, then*

$$\mathfrak{C}(D') \subseteq \mathfrak{C}(D) \quad \text{and} \quad \mathfrak{H}_-(D') \subseteq \mathfrak{H}_-(D).$$

Proof. Every world satisfying the stronger data set also satisfies the weaker one; applying π_- preserves inclusion. $\square$

Corollary 3.2 (Past rigidity persists under consistent refinement). *If D is past-rigid, $D \preceq D'$, and $\mathfrak{C}(D') \neq \emptyset$, then D' is past-rigid with the same past projection.*

Remark 3.3 (Non-rewriting principle). *Set refinement removes incompatible completions; it does not alter the histories carried by completions that remain. No physical rewriting of the past is implied.*

4 Observable past versus hidden past

Let $Q_- : \mathcal{H}_- \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_-$ encode accessible historical records and define

$$\mathfrak{O}_-(D) = Q_-(\mathfrak{H}_-(D)).$$

Proposition 4.1 (Observable rigidity criterion). *$\mathfrak{O}_-(D)$ is a singleton if and only if $\mathfrak{H}_-(D)$ is nonempty and Q_- is constant on $\mathfrak{H}_-(D)$. Observable-past rigidity can coexist with hidden-past ambiguity.*

Proof. The criterion follows directly from the image definition. For the counterexample, take $\mathfrak{H}_-(D) = \{h_1, h_2\}$ with $h_1 \neq h_2$ and $Q_-(h_1) = Q_-(h_2)$. $\square$

Equality of records for one pair does not establish rigidity of a larger past-completion set.

5 Deterministic future with ambiguous past

Let $T : X \rightarrow X$ be deterministic. A full backward history ending at x_0 is

$$(x_0, x_{-1}, x_{-2}, \dots), \quad T(x_{-n}) = x_{-(n-1)}.$$

Define

$$\widehat{X} = \{(x_0, x_{-1}, \dots) \in X^{\mathbb{N}_0} : T(x_{-n}) = x_{-(n-1)}, n \geq 1\}, \quad p_0(\widehat{x}) = x_0.$$

Histories over a fixed x_0 form the fibre $p_0^{-1}(x_0)$, not the entire history space. For a continuous map on a topological space, use the subspace topology inherited from the product. These inverse-limit constructions are standard; the doubling-map case is the dyadic solenoid [7, Section 1].

Proposition 5.1 (Forward uniqueness and backward ambiguity). *The forward orbit of x_0 is unique. Noninjectivity may allow multiple full backward histories, but does not guarantee their existence or multiplicity over every state.*

Proof. The forward orbit is $(x_0, T(x_0), T^2(x_0), \dots)$. The doubling map below supplies an example of multiple full histories. In contrast, for $T : \mathbb{N}_0 \rightarrow \mathbb{N}_0$ with $T(0) = 1$ and $T(n) = n$ for $n \geq 1$, no full history ends at 0. Over 1 the only full history is $(1, 1, \dots)$, since a predecessor 0 cannot be continued backward. $\square$

6 Benchmark: doubling map

Let $X = \mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z}$ and $T(x) = 2x \pmod{1}$. Each present state has two one-step predecessors.

Theorem 6.1 (Cantor family of compatible full pasts). *For every $x_0 \in X$, the natural-extension fibre over x_0 is homeomorphic to $\{0, 1\}^{\mathbb{N}}$.*

Proof. Fix the representative $r_0 \in [0, 1)$ of x_0 . Given $\epsilon \in \{0, 1\}^{\mathbb{N}}$, put

$$r_n = (r_{n-1} + \epsilon_n)/2, \quad x_{-n} = [r_n].$$

Every history has unique representatives $r_n \in [0, 1)$ and recovers the bits by $\epsilon_n = 2r_n - r_{n-1} \in \{0, 1\}$. The coding is therefore bijective. Each coordinate depends only on a finite prefix of bits, so the coding is continuous. Its domain is compact and the fibre is Hausdorff, hence the inverse is continuous. The identification uses the chosen branch labels; no global continuous inverse branch on the circle is asserted. $\square$

Corollary 6.2 (Finite backward records). *Fixing any finite number of backward branch choices still leaves a Cantor family of compatible full histories.*

Proof. Deleting the finitely many fixed bit coordinates leaves a countably infinite set of free coordinates, whose product is homeomorphic to $\{0, 1\}^{\mathbb{N}}$. For a fixed initial block these free coordinates describe older histories. $\square$

7 Physical inverse benchmark: retrospective smoothing of a diffusion

The doubling-map benchmark is exact and topological but not yet a physical inverse problem. We now add a standard stochastic-state-estimation benchmark. Fixed-interval smoothing estimates an earlier state using observations that occur after that state; in the linear Gaussian case the classical Rauch–Tung–Striebel smoother gives a closed-form solution [4, Section 3.2] [5, Section 12.2, Theorem 12.2]. The formulas below use direct Gaussian conditioning, not an implementation or a new derivation of the RTS recursion.

7.1 Gaussian retrospective contraction

Fix a previously observed data value $A = a$ and work throughout under its declared conditional law. Let $X \in \mathbb{R}^n$ denote a past state and $Z \in \mathbb{R}^m$ later data. Under this fixed law, assume (X, Z) is jointly Gaussian with means m_X, m_Z and covariance

$$\begin{pmatrix} P & C \\ C^\top & S \end{pmatrix}, \quad S \succ 0.$$

Theorem 7.1 (Later Gaussian data cannot increase past covariance). *The conditional covariance of the earlier state after incorporating the later data is*

$$P_{\text{smooth}} = P - CS^{-1}C^\top.$$

Hence

$$0 \preceq P_{\text{smooth}} \preceq P.$$

Moreover, the reduction is strict in every direction coupled to the later data through C .

Proof. Set $E = X - m_X - CS^{-1}(Z - m_Z)$. Then $\text{Cov}(E, Z) = 0$, so Gaussianity makes E and Z independent. The continuous Gaussian conditional kernel is

$$X \mid Z = z \sim \mathcal{N}(m_X + CS^{-1}(z - m_Z), P - CS^{-1}C^\top),$$

where degenerate Gaussian laws are allowed. This is the standard conditioning formula [5, Appendix A.1, Lemma A.3]. In particular, $P - CS^{-1}C^\top = \text{Cov}(E) \succeq 0$. Since $S^{-1} \succ 0$,

$$CS^{-1}C^\top \succeq 0,$$

so $P_{\text{smooth}} \preceq P$. For a vector v ,

$$v^\top (P - P_{\text{smooth}})v = (C^\top v)^\top S^{-1}(C^\top v),$$

which is positive exactly when $C^\top v \neq 0$. □

Definition 7.2 (Retrospective covariance gain). *Define*

$$\Delta P := P - P_{\text{smooth}} = CS^{-1}C^\top \succeq 0.$$

Remark 7.3 (Probabilistic extension). *All covariances above refer to the same fixed earlier data value $A = a$. The theorem controls covariance, and does not assert nesting of supports or of prior and posterior credible regions: their means may differ. In the scalar nondegenerate Gaussian benchmark, central intervals of a fixed probability become shorter, but may move outside the prior interval. A zero coupling $C = 0$ gives no reduction. Positive residual covariance is not guaranteed by the general theorem; it is established separately below. Outside Gaussian models, pointwise monotonicity of conditional variance is not asserted. Exact hard-constraint refinement and probabilistic smoothing remain distinct layers.*

7.2 Brownian bridge as an exactly solvable physical model

Fix $x_0 \in \mathbb{R}$, $T > 0$, and diffusivity $\kappa > 0$. Let

$$X_t = x_0 + \sqrt{2\kappa} B_t, \quad 0 \leq t \leq T.$$

The coefficient κ has units of length squared per unit time and is distinct from the evidence symbol D . Here B is standard Brownian motion. This is an idealized physical diffusion model, rather than an experimental validation of any specific system; see [6] for Brownian-motion background.

Before any later observation,

$$X_t \sim \mathcal{N}(x_0, 2\kappa t).$$

Suppose an exact later endpoint $X_T = b$ is learned. This is an idealized observation. To define its conditional law despite $\mathbb{P}(X_T = b) = 0$, work on the Polish space

$$\mathcal{W}_T = \{w \in C([0, T], \mathbb{R}) : w(0) = x_0\}$$

with the uniform topology and its Borel sigma-field. For every $b \in \mathbb{R}$, let K_b be the law of

$$U_t^b = x_0 + \frac{t}{T}(b - x_0) + \sqrt{2\kappa} \left(B_t - \frac{t}{T}B_T \right), \quad 0 \leq t \leq T.$$

The residual Gaussian bridge has zero covariance with B_T at every time. Thus its finite-dimensional vectors are independent of B_T ; continuity and evaluations at rational times extend this to the path sigma-field. Since $X_t = x_0 + t(X_T - x_0)/T + \sqrt{2\kappa}(B_t - tB_T/T)$, it follows that

$$\mathbb{P}(X \in F, X_T \in E) = \int_E K_b(F) \mathbb{P}_{X_T}(db)$$

for Borel $F \subseteq \mathcal{W}_T$ and $E \subseteq \mathbb{R}$. Translation by the continuous mean path makes $b \mapsto K_b$ weakly continuous, in particular a measurable probability kernel. An arbitrary regular conditional law is determined only $\mathbb{P}_{X_T}$ -almost everywhere; this explicit kernel selects a version for every b . The notation $X \mid X_T = b$ refers to K_b , not to division by a zero event probability. This residual construction is classical [8, Theorem 22.1 and the following remark]. Its covariance is

$$\text{Cov}_{K_b}(X_s, X_t) = 2\kappa \left(\min(s, t) - \frac{st}{T} \right).$$

Theorem 7.4 (Past uncertainty contracts but does not collapse). *Conditioned on the later endpoint $X_T = b$,*

$$X_t \mid X_T = b \sim \mathcal{N} \left(x_0 + \frac{t}{T}(b - x_0), 2\kappa \frac{t(T-t)}{T} \right).$$

Therefore

$$0 < 2\kappa \frac{t(T-t)}{T} < 2\kappa t \quad (0 < t < T).$$

The later exact observation strictly reduces uncertainty about the earlier state, but it does not determine that earlier state uniquely.

Proof. The pair (X_t, X_T) is jointly Gaussian with

$$\text{Var}(X_t) = 2\kappa t, \quad \text{Var}(X_T) = 2\kappa T, \quad \text{Cov}(X_t, X_T) = 2\kappa t.$$

Applying Theorem 7.1 gives

$$\text{Var}(X_t \mid X_T) = 2\kappa t - \frac{(2\kappa t)^2}{2\kappa T} = 2\kappa \frac{t(T-t)}{T}.$$

The Gaussian conditional-mean formula gives the stated mean. □

Corollary 7.5 (A full past path remains non-unique). *The kernel K_b is a Brownian-bridge law on continuous paths and is not concentrated on a single trajectory. It assigns probability zero to every countable family of trajectories.*

Proof. Fix $t_* \in (0, T)$. Its evaluation marginal under K_b is a nondegenerate Gaussian law. Every singleton path imposes a singleton evaluation value, which has probability zero. Countable unions of such singleton paths also have probability zero. □

Remark 7.6. *In this benchmark declare hard-constraint compatibility by*

$$\mathfrak{C}(x_0) = \mathcal{W}_T, \quad \mathfrak{C}(x_0, b) = \{w \in \mathcal{W}_T : w(T) = b\}.$$

The endpoint fibre is a proper subset of $\mathcal{W}_T$, and K_b is concentrated on it. These are compatibility classes, not sets of paths with positive singleton probability. For the full past before T , take $\pi_-(w) = w|_{[0,T]}$ and its codomain to be $\pi_-(\mathcal{W}_T)$. Continuity makes this restriction injective. Its endpoint-conditioned image is therefore a proper subset of the prior image, characterized by limit b as $t \uparrow T$. It remains uncountable by the preceding corollary.

By contrast, for any fixed $\tau < T$, the projected compatibility set of fragments on $[0, \tau]$ is unchanged: every continuous fragment starting at x_0 can be extended continuously to b at T . Its projected conditional law nevertheless has reduced variance at each $0 < t \leq \tau$. Thus strict whole-history refinement does not imply strict refinement of every earlier historical projection. No claim about topological support equality is inferred from positive variance.

7.3 Noisy later observation

Let the later measurement be

$$Y_T = X_T + \eta, \quad \eta \sim \mathcal{N}(0, R), \quad R > 0,$$

independent of the diffusion.

Proposition 7.7 (Noisy retrospective contraction). *For $0 < t < T$,*

$$\text{Var}(X_t | Y_T) = 2\kappa t - \frac{(2\kappa t)^2}{2\kappa T + R},$$

and

$$0 < \text{Var}(X_t | Y_T) < 2\kappa t.$$

As $R \downarrow 0$, the formula converges to the Brownian-bridge variance; as $R \rightarrow \infty$, it converges to the prior variance. The continuous Gaussian kernel has mean

$$\mathbb{E}[X_t | Y_T = y] = x_0 + \frac{2\kappa t}{2\kappa T + R}(y - x_0).$$

Proof. Use Theorem 7.1 with

$$\text{Cov}(X_t, Y_T) = 2\kappa t, \quad \text{Var}(Y_T) = 2\kappa T + R.$$

The inequalities follow because $\kappa, t, R > 0$ and $t < T$. □

Remark 7.8 (Noisy compatibility and support). *For observed y , the path likelihood is*

$$L_y(w) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi R}} \exp\left[-\frac{(y - w(T))^2}{2R}\right] > 0.$$

It is bounded and has a finite positive prior integral. Bayes' formula therefore defines a posterior equivalent to the prior path measure: both have the same null sets and the same topological support. If worlds include measurement noise, exact observation constrains (w, η) by $w(T) + \eta = y$, but its projection onto w is all of $\mathcal{W}_T$, since $\eta = y - w(T)$ is always available.

Remark 7.9 (Physical reading). *A later noisy measurement improves retrodiction of an earlier diffusive state without making the past exact. This is standard fixed-interval smoothing behavior, not a WREH discovery. The WREH role of the benchmark is to make the status-of-the-past distinction operational: later evidence can sharpen a past posterior while residual historical ambiguity remains.*

8 Construction order versus internal time

Remark 8.1 (Inference order and temporal order). *The definitions supply an evidence-refinement order and, separately, a declared temporal model. No map identifying the two orders is specified. Any physical identification requires an additional stated bridge. This is a scope convention, not a general impossibility theorem.*

9 Prior-art boundary

Inverse-limit history systems and dyadic solenoids are established objects [7, Section 1]. Gaussian conditioning [5, Appendix A.1], Brownian bridges [8], and retrospective smoothing [4] are classical tools. The image and refinement propositions are elementary consequences of the definitions. This version organizes these results within the WREH history-projection framework; it claims no theorem priority for them. Originality of the wider classification has not been certified by an exhaustive prior-art comparison. No projective-extension theorem is used: existence of Brownian motion is assumed in the benchmark, and its conditional kernel is constructed explicitly.

10 Open obligations

1. complete the broader prior-art comparison with observability, identifiability, natural extensions, retrodiction, and reconstruction under partial observations; the source mapping for the specific benchmarks is recorded in the accompanying repair audit;
2. retain the distinction between a framework exposition and a new technical theorem; upstream DOI records have been checked, while a full cross-manuscript duplication audit remains separate;
3. extend the diffusion benchmark to a finite-dimensional state-space smoother with several observation times and compare exact-set versus probabilistic historical uncertainty;
4. finite-resolution observable-past equivalence;
5. a non-duplicative topological or metric theory of past-completion sets;
6. an HTML demo of backward-history branching and evidence refinement.

Conclusion

Knowing a present response, knowing that a global completion exists, knowing a unique hidden past, and knowing a unique observable past are distinct statements. Under accumulated hard constraints the compatible completion classes are nested, possibly equal; no rewriting operation is required. Noninvertible deterministic dynamics provides a clean benchmark in which the future is unique while the full past remains highly nonunique. In the Brownian endpoint benchmark, later observations reduce interior-state variance without determining a unique path. Exact endpoint data restrict full histories before T , but need not exclude any fragment on a fixed interval ending strictly before T . Noisy Gaussian endpoint data preserve path-measure support. These conclusions refer to different declared mathematical objects.

Review status. This is a repaired review draft, not a publication-ready release. The broader prior-art and cross-manuscript checks listed above remain open. Content licence: CC BY 4.0, subject to the repository's third-party-material exclusions.

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